

MIGUEL MELENDEZ

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Professional Summary

Resourceful and adaptable professional with a background in law and over 5 years of experience in natural resource management, bushland conservation, and stakeholder engagement. Passionate about IT and Linux systems, with emerging expertise in system administration, open-source technologies, and AI applications. Experienced in leading teams, conducting environmental assessments, and building strong community and stakeholder partnerships. Committed to continuous learning, workplace wellbeing, and innovation.

Key Skills

- Natural Resource & Bushland Management
 - Environmental Project Coordination & Reporting
 - Hazard Assessment & Risk Mitigation
 - Stakeholder Engagement, Public Education & Conflict Resolution
 - GIS Mapping & Data Management
 - Linux Fundamentals & Open-Source Systems
 - AI Tools, Scripting & Cloud-Based Platforms
 - Leadership, Collaboration & Cultural Sensitivity
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Professional Experience

Leading Hand – Natural Resource Management

Melbourne Water, Central Region | 2022 – 2025

- **Directed complex operational field plans**, empowering cross-functional teams to successfully execute targeted conservation and habitat restoration goals within strict environmental constraints.
- **Executed precision flora and fauna surveys**, capturing high-quality spatial data to enhance GIS mapping accuracy and directly inform strategic resource management reporting.
- **Conducted dynamic risk assessments in high-risk field environments**, decisively implementing emergency response protocols and safe site evacuations to ensure zero workplace injuries and adherence to WHS policies.
- **Negotiated and de-escalated sensitive operational issues** with local councils, contractors, and private landowners, transforming potential conflicts into collaborative partnerships to ensure uninterrupted project delivery.

Project Support Officer – Central Region

Melbourne Water | 2022

- **Facilitated the end-to-end delivery of regional natural resource management initiatives** by coordinating logistics, optimising project documentation, and driving effective stakeholder engagement.
- **Administered strict on-ground compliance** with local council frameworks and environmental regulations, ensuring absolute operational integrity across all field sites.
- **Meticulously maintained operational data systems**, guaranteeing that all project execution and financial reporting strictly adhered to complex multi-tiered funding agreements.

Bush Crew Team Member & Leading Hand – NRM Projects

Platypus Environmental Services | 2017 – 2020

- **Supervised specialised operational field crews** to safely deliver large-scale bushland restoration projects across Victoria, ensuring all output met rigorous quality metrics.
- **Produced comprehensive environmental impact reports**, aligning on-the-ground data with state and local government regulatory standards.
- **Forged strategic partnerships** with Melbourne Water and local municipal councils, aligning field tactics with broader regional conservation goals to consistently meet critical project milestones.

Legal Assistant & Community Liaison

Government of Carabobo, Venezuela | 2012 – 2014

- Supported families in domestic violence cases through legal advice and advocacy.

- Coordinated with social programs to deliver integrated community support.
- Drafted legal documentation and facilitated negotiations.
- Developed early skills in public service, advocacy, and stakeholder engagement.

Volunteer Experience

Volunteer – Men’s Shed

United AgeCare, Victoria | Nov 2025 – March 2026

- Facilitate social connection and community engagement for elderly participants through hands-on woodworking and DIY projects.
- Maintain workshop tools and machinery, ensuring all equipment is operated according to safety protocols.
- Provide mentorship and support to members, fostering a positive environment that promotes men’s mental health and wellbeing.
- Collaborate with United AgeCare staff to coordinate weekly activities and manage shed logistics, and provide proactive assistance with any additional operation needs.

Education & Formal Qualifications

- Graduate Certificate in Information Technology | *RMIT University* | 2026
 - **Key Subjects:** Database Concepts, IT Infrastructure & Security, Programming Fundamentals.
- Certificate III in Production Horticulture (AHC30616) | *Australian College of Agriculture & Horticulture* | 2018
 - **Key competencies:** Developed workplace sustainability policies, climate risk management strategies, and WHS processes.
- Certificate III in Light Vehicle Mechanical Technology (AUR30612) | *Australian Education Academy* | 2017
- **Bachelor of Law** | University of Carabobo, Venezuela | 2012

Professional Development & Micro Credentials

Data Systems, AI & Infrastructure

- Technical & Data Systems (TAFE NSW)
 - Introduction to Data Centres | Institute of Applied Technology Digital / TAFE NSW | 2026
 - Introduction to SQL | TAFE NSW | 2025
 - Introduction to Data Analytics & Artificial Intelligence | *Institute of Applied Technology Digital / TAFE NSW* | 2025.
 - Introduction to Modern AI | *Cisco Networking Academy* | 2025
- Project Management & Executive Leadership
 - Artificial Intelligence for Project Managers (PMI & CPE Accredited) | *LinkedIn Learning* | 2023
 - Creating a Positive & Healthy Work Environment (SHRM & PMI Accredited) | *LinkedIn Learning* | 2022
 - Collaborative Leadership & Improving Leadership Communications | *LinkedIn Learning* | 2022

High-Risk Licences & Field Tickets

Work Safely at Heights & Chainsaw Operation | *Fire & Safety Aus* | 2019–2023

First Aid (HLTAID011) & CPR (HLTAID009) | *St John / Chisholm* | Updated 2023

Agricultural Chemical User Permit (ACUP)

Languages

- Spanish (Native)
- English (Fluent)

References

Available upon request.